development. The focus therefore is on three levers for change in Pakistani society:

1. education for knowledge and empowerment
2. gainful employment
3. engagement: voice, identity, inclusion and citizenship

The report, which is based on a large survey and focus group discussions with young people around Pakistan, defines the 'more intangible' third driver of change of citizenship as the youth's voice, identity, sociopolitical participation, marriage, societal inclusion and exclusion, radicalization and social attitudes. Without meaningful engagement, the report concludes, young people will not feel that there are opportunities for social, political and institutional integration into the fabric of society and its collective decisions (p. v). Reflecting the conclusions drawn in this book's chapter on political participation, the report explains why it is no surprise that there is little engagement with community and political affairs, and young people's aspirations, hopes, challenges and fears are not heard (pp. 7–8, 22). Pakistan is not a country that values its youth: 94 per cent of those taking part in the UNDP research do not have access to a library while 93 per cent do not have access to a sports facility. Seventy-seven per cent do not have any personal means of transportation, in a country with a dearth of public transport (p. 34). Despite all the social issues faced by the country's youth and increasing security concerns, the UNDP reports that an overwhelming number of young people are optimistic about Pakistan – of those surveyed, 70 per cent feel safe, 89 per cent feel happy, and 67 per cent feel that their life is better than their parents' (p. 34). These positive attitudes are reported notwithstanding Pakistan's large social disparities in terms of education, employment and income. While the report does not expand on the reasons for this optimism, there is nonetheless an element of hope that the report highlights, where such optimism can be harnessed towards progress and development for Pakistan.[9]

The problem with engagement

According to the UNDP report, providing young people with education and employment possibilities does not empower them unless they themselves feel that they can, in some capacity, influence or determine the decisions that shape their lives.

> Engagement is not simply an end itself but also the means to an end, towards an informed, engaged and responsible citizenry in control of the decisions that